INDEPENDENCE & PARTITION (1946–1947)

CABINET MISSION ATTEMPTED UNITY → DIRECT ACTION DAY: CALL → VIOLENCE OF 1946-47 WITHOUT → TWO ATTLEE STATEMENTS, ONE → MOUNTBATTEN AND THE ACCELERATED → 3 JUNE PLAN: A

Read the thick cyan rail from Stage 00 to the final core synthesis. Each card uses a concept-appropriate structure; the grey E card is optional enrichment only and never repairs missing core content.

◆ PRIMARY CORE FLOW ◆ SUBORDINATE EXTRA ◆ APPROVAL / REVIEW

CORE BEFORE EXTRA • prior artefacts unchanged • exact same master drives poster and tiles

Approval: FALSE • Pending user review • source generation g3 and all prior artifacts unchanged

00

STAGE 00

CABINET MISSION ATTEMPTED UNITY

CABINET MISSION ATTEMPTED UNITY · CABINET MISSION 1946 · UNITY ATTEMPT, NOT A PARTITION INSTRUMENT · A SOVEREIGN PAKISTAN · UNION + GROUPS OF PROVINCES + PROVINCES (WEAK CENTRE) · ACCEPTED (IN SOME FORM) · BY BOTH PARTIES IN JUNE AND JULY 1946 · INCOMPATIBLE READINGS

CABINET MISSION 1946 → UNITY ATTEMPT, NOT A PARTITION INSTRUMENT → REJECTED → a sovereign Pakistan → PROPOSED → Union + groups of provinces + provinces (weak centre) → ACCEPTED (in some form) → by both parties in June and July 1946 → COLLAPSE → incompatible readings → withdrawal → loss of trust → Partition

CORE CLAIM
- CABINET MISSION 1946 → UNITY ATTEMPT, NOT A PARTITION INSTRUMENT
- REJECTED → a sovereign Pakistan
- PROPOSED → Union + groups of provinces + provinces (weak centre)

MECHANISM
- ACCEPTED (in some form) → by both parties in June and July 1946
- COLLAPSE → incompatible readings → withdrawal → loss of trust → Partition
- RULE → the Mission is where unity was last available, not where it ended.

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
- MUST REMEMBER: The 1946 elections, Cabinet Mission breakdown, Direct Action Day on 16 August.
- Interim Government from 2 September, Attlee statement of 20 February 1947 and 3 June Plan led to the Independence Act.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: RULE → the Mission is where unity was last available, not where it ended.

01

STAGE 01

DIRECT ACTION DAY: CALL, KILLINGS, CONSEQUENCES

DIRECT ACTION DAY · CALL, KILLINGS, CONSEQUENCES · 16 AUG 1946 · THREE SEPARABLE THINGS · POLITICAL CALL · MUSLIM LEAGUE, AFTER DEADLOCK AND ITS OWN WITHDRAWAL · MASS KILLINGS REMEMBERED AS THE GREAT CALCUTTA KILLINGS · LATER REGIONAL VIOLENCE

16 AUG 1946 → DIRECT ACTION DAY → three separable things → POLITICAL CALL → Muslim League, after deadlock and its own withdrawal → CALCUTTA → mass killings remembered as the Great Calcutta Killings → LATER REGIONAL VIOLENCE → separate local actors, triggers and sequences → ORDER → Direct Action precedes the Congress-only Interim Government (2 Sep 1946)

CORE CLAIM
- 16 AUG 1946 → DIRECT ACTION DAY → three separable things
- POLITICAL CALL → Muslim League, after deadlock and its own withdrawal

MECHANISM
- CALCUTTA → mass killings remembered as the Great Calcutta Killings
- LATER REGIONAL VIOLENCE → separate local actors, triggers and sequences

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
- ORDER → Direct Action precedes the Congress-only Interim Government (2 Sep 1946)
- RULE → separate call, killings and spread; assign agency to actors, not communities.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: RULE → separate call, killings and spread; assign agency to actors, not communities.

02

STAGE 02

VIOLENCE OF 1946-47 WITHOUT COLLECTIVE GUILT

VIOLENCE OF 1946-47 WITHOUT COLLECTIVE GUILT · 1946-47 VIOLENCE · RECIPROCAL WAVES, REGIONALLY SPECIFIC · PUNJAB (EACH WITH ITS OWN ACTORS AND TRIGGERS) · ORGANISATIONS, ARMED BANDS, RUMOUR, COLLAPSE OF POLICING · REGIONAL SPLIT · PUNJAB AND BENGAL · TERRITORIAL DIVISION AND MASS VIOLENCE

1946-47 VIOLENCE → reciprocal waves, regionally specific

NOAKHALI → BIHAR → PUNJAB (each with its own actors and triggers) → DRIVERS → organisations, armed bands, rumour, collapse of policing → REGIONAL SPLIT → Punjab and Bengal: territorial division and mass violence

CORE CLAIM
- 1946-47 VIOLENCE → reciprocal waves, regionally specific
- NOAKHALI → BIHAR → PUNJAB (each with its own actors and triggers)

MECHANISM
- DRIVERS → organisations, armed bands, rumour, collapse of policing
- REGIONAL SPLIT → Punjab and Bengal: territorial division and mass violence

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
- elsewhere: political settlement and a minority question
- RULE → agency belongs to organisations and leaderships, never to whole communities.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: RULE → agency belongs to organisations and leaderships, never to whole communities.

03

STAGE 03

TWO ATTLEE STATEMENTS, ONE DEADLINE

TWO ATTLEE STATEMENTS, ONE DEADLINE · TWO ATTLEE STATEMENTS · DO NOT CONFLATE · 15 MAR 1946 · "A MINORITY WILL NOT BE ALLOWED TO PLACE A · 20 FEB 1947 · TRANSFER TO RESPONSIBLE INDIAN HANDS, NOT LATER THAN JUNE · A PUBLISHED OUTER LIMIT CONVERTS NEGOTIATION INTO A RACE

CORE CLAIM	MECHANISM	CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
TWO ATTLEE STATEMENTS → do not conflate	20 FEB 1947 → transfer to responsible Indian hands, not later than June 1948	RULE → one is about the veto, the other is about the deadline.
15 MAR 1946 → "a minority will not be allowed to place a veto" → pre-Mission	EFFECT → a published outer limit converts negotiation into a race against a date	TWO ATTLEE STATEMENTS → do not conflate

CORE CLAIM
- TWO ATTLEE STATEMENTS → do not conflate
- 15 MAR 1946 → "a minority will not be allowed to place a veto" → pre-Mission

MECHANISM
- 20 FEB 1947 → transfer to responsible Indian hands, not later than June 1948
- EFFECT → a published outer limit converts negotiation into a race against a date

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
- RULE → one is about the veto, the other is about the deadline.
- TWO ATTLEE STATEMENTS → do not conflate

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: RULE → one is about the veto, the other is about the deadline.

04

STAGE 04

MOUNTBATTEN AND THE ACCELERATED TIMETABLE

MOUNTBATTEN AND THE ACCELERATED TIMETABLE · MAR 1947 · MOUNTBATTEN ARRIVES AS LAST VICEROY · JUNE 1948 OUTER LIMIT COMPRESSED TO AUGUST 1947 · ADMINISTRATIVE, MILITARY AND BOUNDARY ARRANGEMENTS LEFT INCOMPLETE · ANALYTICAL PLACE · EXPLAINS EXECUTION AND DISORDER, NOT THE CHOICE TO PARTITION · HASTE BELONGS IN CONSEQUENCES, NOT IN CAUSES.

MAR 1947 → MOUNTBATTEN ARRIVES AS LAST VICEROY → DEADLINE → June 1948 outer limit compressed to August 1947 → CONSEQUENCE → administrative, military and boundary arrangements left incomplete → ANALYTICAL PLACE → explains execution and disorder, not the choice to partition → RULE → haste belongs in consequences, not in causes.

CORE CLAIM
- MAR 1947 → MOUNTBATTEN ARRIVES AS LAST VICEROY
- DEADLINE → June 1948 outer limit compressed to August 1947

MECHANISM
- CONSEQUENCE → administrative, military and boundary arrangements left incomplete
- ANALYTICAL PLACE → explains execution and disorder, not the choice to partition

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
- RULE → haste belongs in consequences, not in causes.
- MAR 1947 → MOUNTBATTEN ARRIVES AS LAST VICEROY

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: RULE → haste belongs in consequences, not in causes.

05

STAGE 05

3 JUNE PLAN: A POLITICAL PLAN, NOT AN ACT

3 JUNE PLAN · A POLITICAL PLAN, NOT AN ACT · 3 JUNE 1947 · MOUNTBATTEN PLAN · A POLITICAL PLAN · PARTITION IN PRINCIPLE · PROVIDES FOR · DIVISION OF PUNJAB AND BENGAL

3 JUNE 1947 → MOUNTBATTEN PLAN → a POLITICAL plan

ACCEPTS → Partition in principle → PROVIDES FOR → division of Punjab and Bengal → → referendums in the North-West Frontier Province and Sylhet

CORE CLAIM
- 3 JUNE 1947 → MOUNTBATTEN PLAN → a POLITICAL plan
- ACCEPTS → Partition in principle
- PROVIDES FOR → division of Punjab and Bengal

MECHANISM
- → referendums in the North-West Frontier Province and Sylhet
- → boundary commissions
- LIMIT → not an Act of Parliament; transfers no power by itself

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
- RULE → the political decision precedes the legal enactment of July 1947.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: RULE → the political decision precedes the legal enactment of July 1947.

06

STAGE 06

THREE PARTITION MECHANISMS

THREE PARTITION MECHANISMS · HOW PARTITION WAS CARRIED OUT · THREE DIFFERENT PROCEDURES · ASSEMBLY VOTES · PUNJAB AND BENGAL, BY THE TWO NOTIONAL HALVES OF · NORTH-WEST FRONTIER PROVINCE AND SYLHET DISTRICT OF ASSAM · → BOTH RESULTS TOOK THEM INTO PAKISTAN · BOUNDARY COMMISSIONS

CORE CLAIM	MECHANISM	CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
HOW PARTITION WAS CARRIED OUT → three different procedures	REFERENDUMS → North-West Frontier Province and Sylhet district of Assam	BOUNDARY COMMISSIONS → technical line-drawing, separate from both routes
ASSEMBLY VOTES → Punjab and Bengal, by the two notional halves of each assembly	→ both results took them into Pakistan	RULE → match the province to its mechanism; never swap them.

CORE CLAIM
- HOW PARTITION WAS CARRIED OUT → three different procedures
- ASSEMBLY VOTES → Punjab and Bengal, by the two notional halves of each assembly

MECHANISM
- REFERENDUMS → North-West Frontier Province and Sylhet district of Assam
- → both results took them into Pakistan

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
- BOUNDARY COMMISSIONS → technical line-drawing, separate from both routes
- RULE → match the province to its mechanism; never swap them.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: RULE → match the province to its mechanism; never swap them.

07

STAGE 07

INDIAN INDEPENDENCE ACT: ASSENT AND COMMENCEMENT

INDIAN INDEPENDENCE ACT · ASSENT AND COMMENCEMENT · THE LEGAL ENACTMENT · ROYAL ASSENT · 18 JULY 1947 (WESTMINSTER) · TWO DOMINIONS, INDIA AND PAKISTAN, FROM 15 AUGUST 1947 · ALSO PROVIDES · LAPSE OF BRITISH PARAMOUNTCY OVER THE PRINCELY STATES

INDIAN INDEPENDENCE ACT → the LEGAL enactment → ROYAL ASSENT → 18 July 1947 (Westminster) → COMMENCEMENT → two dominions, India and Pakistan, from 15 August 1947 → ALSO PROVIDES → lapse of British paramountcy over the princely states → SEQUENCE → 3 June political plan → 18 July assent → 15 August commencement

CORE CLAIM
- INDIAN INDEPENDENCE ACT → the LEGAL enactment
- ROYAL ASSENT → 18 July 1947 (Westminster)

MECHANISM
- COMMENCEMENT → two dominions, India and Pakistan, from 15 August 1947
- ALSO PROVIDES → lapse of British paramountcy over the princely states

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
- SEQUENCE → 3 June political plan → 18 July assent → 15 August commencement
- RULE → assent and commencement are separate legal events.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: RULE → assent and commencement are separate legal events.

08

STAGE 08

STATUTORY COMMENCEMENT VERSUS COMMEMORATIVE OBSERVANCE

STATUTORY COMMENCEMENT VERSUS COMMEMORATIVE OBSERVANCE · WHAT THE STATUTE SAYS · WHAT COMMEMORATION SAYS BOTH DOMINIONS CREATED · PAKISTAN OBSERVES 14 AUGUST AS ITS NATIONAL DAY FROM · CEREMONIES AT KARACHI (14TH) AND DELHI (15TH) · STATUTORY COMMENCEMENT IS ONE DATE; COMMEMORATIVE OBSERVANCE IS ANOTHER.

CORE CLAIM	MECHANISM	CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
WHAT THE STATUTE SAYS	Pakistan observes 14 August as its national day from 15 August 1947	RULE → statutory commencement is one date; commemorative observance is another.
WHAT COMMEMORATION SAYS both dominions created	ceremonies at Karachi (14th) and Delhi (15th)	WHAT THE STATUTE SAYS

CORE CLAIM
- WHAT THE STATUTE SAYS
- WHAT COMMEMORATION SAYS both dominions created

MECHANISM
- Pakistan observes 14 August as its national day from 15 August 1947
- ceremonies at Karachi (14th) and Delhi (15th)

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
- RULE → statutory commencement is one date; commemorative observance is another.
- WHAT THE STATUTE SAYS

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: RULE → statutory commencement is one date; commemorative observance is another.

09

STAGE 09

THE LAPSE OF PARAMOUNTCY

THE LAPSE OF PARAMOUNTCY · LAPSED (IT DID NOT TRANSFER) · NOT INHERITED · NEITHER DOMINION SUCCEEDED TO SUZERAINTY AUTOMATICALLY · EACH STATE'S RELATIONSHIP HAD TO BE CREATED AFRESH · ACCESSION OR AGREEMENT, NEGOTIATED STATE BY STATE · "LAPSED" IS THE OPERATIVE VERB; "TRANSFERRED" IS THE ERROR. · CLOSE DISTINCTION

PARAMOUNTCY → LAPSED (it did not transfer) → NOT INHERITED → neither dominion succeeded to suzerainty automatically → CONSEQUENCE → each state's relationship had to be created afresh → ROUTE → accession or agreement, negotiated state by state → RULE → "lapsed" is the operative verb; "transferred" is the error.

CORE CLAIM
- PARAMOUNTCY → LAPSED (it did not transfer)
- NOT INHERITED → neither dominion succeeded to suzerainty automatically
- CONSEQUENCE → each state's relationship had to be created afresh

MECHANISM
- ROUTE → accession or agreement, negotiated state by state
- RULE → "lapsed" is the operative verb; "transferred" is the error.
- CLOSE DISTINCTION: The Indian Independence Act received royal assent on 18 July 1947

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
- transfer dates, Radcliffe Award publication and mass displacement must remain separately dated.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: RULE → "lapsed" is the operative verb; "transferred" is the error.

10

STAGE 10

RADCLIFFE: TWO COMMISSIONS, AWARDS OF 17 AUGUST

TWO COMMISSIONS, AWARDS OF 17 AUGUST · BOUNDARY MECHANISM · TWO COMMISSIONS, ONE CHAIRMAN · PUNJAB COMMISSION · BENGAL COMMISSION · CHAIRED BY CYRIL RADCLIFFE · EQUAL CONGRESS-NOMINATED AND LEAGUE-NOMINATED JUDGES · MEMBERS DIVIDE

BOUNDARY MECHANISM → two commissions, one chairman → PUNJAB COMMISSION → BENGAL COMMISSION → chaired by Cyril Radcliffe → COMPOSITION → equal Congress-nominated and League-nominated judges → DEADLOCK → members divide → decisions fall to the chairman

CORE CLAIM
- BOUNDARY MECHANISM → two commissions, one chairman
- PUNJAB COMMISSION
- BENGAL COMMISSION → chaired by Cyril Radcliffe
- COMPOSITION → equal Congress-nominated and League-nominated judges

MECHANISM
- DEADLOCK → members divide → decisions fall to the chairman
- 15 AUG 1947 → transfer of power
- 17 AUG 1947 → awards published
- CONSEQUENCE → border districts uncertain; violence already under way before the line.

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
- EVIDENCE LIMIT: Partition requires League, Congress, British, provincial and popular agency plus gendered violence and refugee evidence
- communal inevitability and single-person blame are both inadequate.

MECHANISM / VERDICT — CONSEQUENCE → border districts uncertain; violence already under way before the line.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: EVIDENCE LIMIT: Partition requires League, Congress, British, provincial and popular agency plus gendered violence and refugee evidence; communal inevitability and single-person blame are both inadequate.

11

STAGE 11

RESPONSIBILITY, CONTINGENCY AND THE THREE REGISTERS

RESPONSIBILITY, CONTINGENCY AND THE THREE REGISTERS · CONGRESS ACCEPTANCE · RELUCTANT AND PRAGMATIC; DEADLOCK, VIOLENCE, GOVERNABILITY · STRUCTURE (1909 ONWARDS) + CONTINGENCY (DATED 1946-47 DECISIONS) · BRITISH POLICY · MUSLIM LEAGUE · COMMUNAL ORGANISATIONS · MASS FEAR AND REGIONAL DYNAMICS; NO SINGLE VILLAIN

CONGRESS ACCEPTANCE → reluctant and pragmatic; deadlock, violence, governability → (INEVITABILITY → structure (1909 onwards) + contingency (dated 1946-47 decisions)) → RESPONSIBILITY → British policy → Muslim League → communal organisations

CORE CLAIM
- CONGRESS ACCEPTANCE → reluctant and pragmatic; deadlock, violence, governability
- INEVITABILITY → structure (1909 onwards) + contingency (dated 1946-47 decisions)
- RESPONSIBILITY → British policy
- Muslim League

MECHANISM
- communal organisations
- mass fear and regional dynamics; no single villain
- THREE REGISTERS → legal transfer
- political triumph

CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT
- humanitarian catastrophe
- HUMAN COST → displacement around 10 to 15 million (broad estimate); deaths contested
- GANDHI → in Calcutta and Bengal for communal peace, not celebrating in Delhi
- RULE → record all three registers; a one-sided verdict answers only part.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: RULE → record all three registers; a one-sided verdict answers only part.

E

EXTRA

SUBORDINATE ENRICHMENT — ONLY AFTER THE COMPLETE CORE

OPTIONAL ADVANCED ENRICHMENT · INDIA'S STRUGGLE FOR INDEPENDENCE TREATS PARTITION AS THE TRAGIC · COMMUNALISATION PROCESS INTENSIFIED BY COLONIAL POLICY, LEAGUE SEPARATISM AND · THE CABINET MISSION SCHEME FAILED BECAUSE CONGRESS VIEWED INDIA · WHILE THE LEAGUE SAW COMPULSORY GROUPING AS THE MINIMUM · DIRECT ACTION DAY AND SUBSEQUENT VIOLENCE CONVERTED ELITE CONSTITUTIONAL · PARTITION CANNOT BE EXPLAINED BY ONE VILLAIN ALONE · IT REQUIRES ANALYSIS OF BRITISH HASTE, LEAGUE INTRANSIGENCE, CONGRESS'S

OPTIONAL SOURCE DEPTH
- India's Struggle for Independence treats Partition as the tragic end of a long
- communalisation process intensified by colonial policy, League separatism and the crisis of transfer.
- The Cabinet Mission scheme failed because Congress viewed India as one sovereign nation-making unit,
- while the League saw compulsory grouping as the minimum safeguard for Muslim-majority zones.

ADVANCED DEBATE
- Direct Action Day and subsequent violence converted elite constitutional disagreement into mass fear and retaliatory communal mobilisation.
- CAUTION: Partition cannot be explained by one villain alone
- it requires analysis of British haste, League intransigence, Congress's acceptance, and the accumulated growth of communal ideology.
- Congress leaders accepted Partition reluctantly because they feared a weak centre, continuing

LEGACY / NUANCE
- communal paralysis and prolonged violence if the Cabinet Mission framework survived unreconciled.
- The 3 June Plan operationalised partition through legislative votes, referendums and boundary commissions.
- The Indian Independence Act created two dominions and allowed princely paramountcy to lapse, creating the next nation-building challenge.
- CAUTION: The human tragedy of Partition lay in the gap between high-political decisions

OPTIONAL STATUS — This optional depth is unnecessary for a competent core answer; use it only for added nuance after the complete core has been written.

END OF MASTER CANVAS • poster embeds this exact master • tiled pages are overlapping crops of the same pixels